

Vietnamese Pho recipe

Serves 6 · Protein: / 3lb beef brisket → beef

150 g / 5oz ginger (, sliced down the centre)	toast	boil 5 min	boil	cover	simmer 40 min	serve
3 cloves ((the spice cloves!))						
1 kg / 2lb marrow bones ((leg, knuckle), cut to reveal marrow)						
5 litres / 3.75 quarts water ((15 cups))						
4 brisket slices ((used for broth))						
2 tbsp white sugar						
1 tbsp salt						
40 ml / 3 tbsp fish sauce ((Note 2))						
50 g / 1.5 oz dried rice sticks ((or 120g/4oz fresh) (Note 3))						
Coriander/cilantro, 3 - 5 sprigs ((or more basil))						
1 kg / 2lb meaty beef bones						
2 large onions (, halved)						
4 cinnamon quills						
4 cardamon pods						
5 tbsp coriander seeds						
5 kg beef						
30 g / 1 oz beef, raw, very thinly sliced ((Note 4))						
Beansprouts, handful						
Thai basil, 3 - 5 sprigs						
Lime wedges*						
Finely sliced red chilli*						
Hoisin sauce*						
Sriracha* ((for spiciness))						

Method

1. Aromatics Heat a heavy based skillet over high heat (no oil) until smoking.
2. Place onion and ginger in pan cut side down.
3. Cook for a few minutes until it's charred, then turn.
4. Remove and set aside.
5. Toast Spices lightly in a dry skillet over medium high heat for 3 minutes. Remove impurities: Rinse bones & brisket then cover with water in large stock pot.
6. Boil for 5 minutes, then drain.
7. Rinse each bone and brisket under tap water.

- 8.** Broth: Wipe pot clean, bring 3.5 litres / 3.75 quarts water to boil.
- 9.** Add bones and brisket, onion, ginger, Spices Add onion, ginger, Spices, sugar and salt - water should just barely cover everything.
- 10.** Cover with lid, simmer 3 hours.
- 11.** Remove brisket (should be fall-apart tender), cool then refrigerate for later.
- 12.** Simmer remaining soup UNCOVERED for 40 minutes.
- 13.** Strain broth into another pot, discard bones and spices.
- 14.** Should be about 2.5 litres / 2.65 quarts (10 cups), if loads more, reduce.
- 15.** Add fish sauce, adjust salt and sugar if needed.
- 16.** Broth should be beefy, fragrant with spices, savoury and barely sweet.
- 17.** Assemble: Prepare rice noodles per packet, just prior to serving.
- 18.** Place noodles in bowl.
- 19.** Top with raw beef and brisket.
- 20.** Ladle over about 400 / 14 oz hot broth - will cook beef to medium rare.
- 21.** Serve with Toppings on the side!